ACSC383 Project - Q and A

- **What is the primary goal of the platform from your perspective (swap, sell, donate, or environmental awareness)?**
  Primary goal: Environmental awareness. The platform prioritizes tracking and communicating environmental impact over commercial transactions.
- **Who are the main user groups you envision using the system (students only, staff, external buyers)?**
  User groups: University members only, specifically students and staff.
- **Should the system support guest users or only registered university-approved accounts?**
  Access: Only registered university-approved accounts, if possible.
- **How should verification of university users be handled (email domain, student ID, manual approval)?**
  Verification: Email verification sent to the user's official university Outlook email address, if possible.
- **Do you want the platform to include built-in messaging, or link users to external communication channels?**
  Messaging: No built-in messaging functionality.
- **Should item listings require admin approval before becoming visible?**
  Moderation: Yes, listings should require admin/moderator approval before becoming visible, if possible.
- **Should the platform include item categories predefined by you, or should users create their own?**
  Categories: Predefined categories only.
- **What exact data fields should be included in an item listing (title, category, condition, photos, etc.)?**
  Fields: Title, description, condition, photos, and price.
- **Should users be allowed to upload multiple images per item? If yes, is there a limit?**
  Images: Yes. A reasonable limit should be enforced, such as up to three images per item with controlled image quality (e.g., ~720px).
- **Do you want location-based search/filtering (e.g., Limassol – Nicosia)?**
  Location: Yes, location-based filtering should be supported.
- **Should the platform support price negotiation or fixed prices only?**
  Pricing: Fixed prices only.
- **Is payment processed through the platform or handled externally between users?**
  Payment: Handled externally between users.
- **How should disputes (fraud, damaged items, no-shows) be handled?**
  Scope: Not applicable; this feature is out of scope.

- **How should CO_2 or waste reduction metrics be calculated (formula provided by you, external dataset, simplified estimation)?**
  Calculation: Based on scientific literature using simplified estimation (law of averages), where an item's category is used to determine average impact values.
- **Do you want the environmental impact shown per item, per user, or aggregated across the whole platform?**
  Impact display: Per user and aggregated across the entire platform.
- **Should the system send notifications (email, SMS, in-app)? If yes, for which events?**
  Notifications: No notifications.
- **Should users be able to save/favorite items?**
  Favorites: Yes, if possible.
- **Should users be able to edit or delete their listings after posting?**
  Editing/Deletion: Yes. However, edited listings should require re-approval by a moderator, if possible.
- **What privacy concerns should we take into account (e.g., hide full names, hide locations)?**
  Privacy: None at this stage.
- **Should the platform track item history (who owned it previously, number of swaps)?**
  Item history: No.
- **Should the system support item bundles or only single-item listings?**
  Listings: Single-item listings only.
- **Should users receive ratings/reviews after transactions?**
  Reviews: Yes, if possible.